



Anchor

steady the day

ANCHOR USER MANUAL

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Contents

1. Introduction & Overview	3
1.1 Project Overview & Intended Users	3
1.2 Web App Website	3
2. Getting Started	4
2.1 Visual Interface	4
2.2 Account Creation & Login	5
3. Key Features & Workflow	6
3.1 Setting Daily Focus	6
3.2 Tracking Progress	7
3.3 Schedule Planning	8
3.4 Evening Reflection	9
3.5 Managing Integration & Preferences	10
4. Known Limitations & Troubleshooting	11
4.1 Known Limitations	11
4.2 Troubleshooting	12
4.3 FAQs	12

1. Introduction & Overview

1.1 Project Overview & Intended Users

Imagine walking out of an important lecture right after your professor announces a quiz for the next class. You rush to the nearest library, find a table, set down your phone and iPad, and adjust your laptop screen to 110° only to freeze. Between revising for the upcoming quiz, finishing other assignments across multiple classes, and managing commitments outside of school, you do not even know where to begin, and doomscrolling will not help you progress any further.

Introducing to you, **Anchor**, an application that is built to help you in these times of decision fatigue. Instead of being overwhelmed with listing your endless amount of tasks and having them lost after, Anchor operates on a simple, grounded philosophy: you will *steady the day* by **limiting your daily focus to 3 core tasks**, or what we like to call, “**Anchors**.”

As you constrain your daily targets to what matters most on the current day, Anchor will break the paralysis of what to start, reduce cognitive overload, and help turn your stressful and chaotic study sessions into calm, intentional progress.

Intended Users: Students, recent graduates, and independent learners looking for a minimalist, low-friction task management tool that prioritizes clarity, focus, and daily reflection over endless accumulation of stress.

1.2 Web App Website

Anchor is accessible directly in your mobile or desktop browser:

URL: <https://sane24.github.io/Anchor-App>

Github Repository: <https://github.com/Sane24/Anchor-App>

1.3 Device and Browser Recommendations

Target Format: Progressive Web App (PWA), optimized for mobile viewports (390px width)

Recommended Devices: Mobile smartphones (iOS / Android) or simulated mobile web views on desktop

Supported Browsers: Google Chrome (v110+), Safari (v16+), or Mozilla Firefox (v110+)

Note: On iPhone Safari, the notification reminders require adding Anchor to your Home Screen (*Share -> Add to Home Screen*) and opening it from there.

2. Getting Started

2.1 Visual Interface



Figure 1: Anchor App Start Page

- 1) **Anchor Logo & Slogan:** Displays the brand logo and slogan while acting as a quick shortcut back to the main *Today* view from anywhere in the app
- 2) **Theme Toggle:** Allows you to switch the app to dark or light mode, based on your preference
- 3) **Morning Briefing Banner:** Allows you to add your tasks based on your choice from what you have entered before
- 4) **Anchor Management Container:** Shows your active daily anchors (up to 3 maximum) and provides text input fields or options to import tasks from connected calendars and email accounts
- 5) **Today Tab:** Navigates directly to your main daily dashboard
- 6) **Garden Tab:** Displays your long-term progress, consistency streaks, and visual growth over time
- 7) **This Week Tab:** Offers a higher-level view of upcoming deadlines, scheduled commitments, and week-at-a-glance planning
- 8) **Reflection Tab:** Opens your evening debrief space to review completed and planned future anchors and log daily notes
- 9) **Settings Tab:** Accesses account preferences, integration connections, and custom display appearance options

2.2 Account Creation & Login

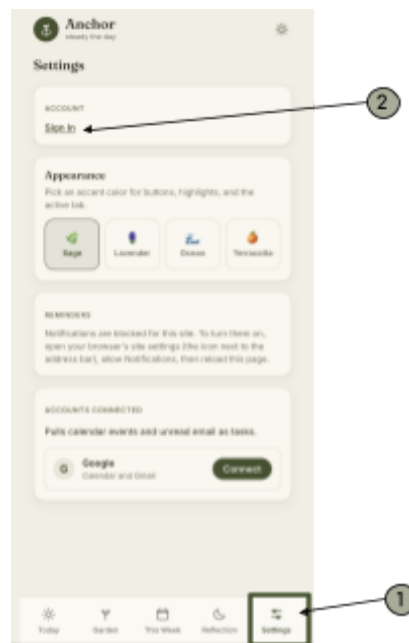


Figure 2: Anchor App Settings Page

- 1) **Navigate to Settings:** Tap the *Settings* icon located on the bottom navigation bar
- 2) **Select Sign In:** Tap *Sign in* at the top of the Settings page
- 3) **Account Credentials:** Sign in using an existing account or select the option to create a new one
- 4) **Password Requirements:** If creating a new password, ensure it meets all of the following criteria:
 - a) At least 8 characters long;
 - b) At least one uppercase letter (A-Z);
 - c) At least one numerical digit (0-9); and
 - d) At least one symbol (!, @, #, \$, %, ^, &, *, -, _, ?)

3. Key Features & Workflow

3.1 Setting Daily Focus

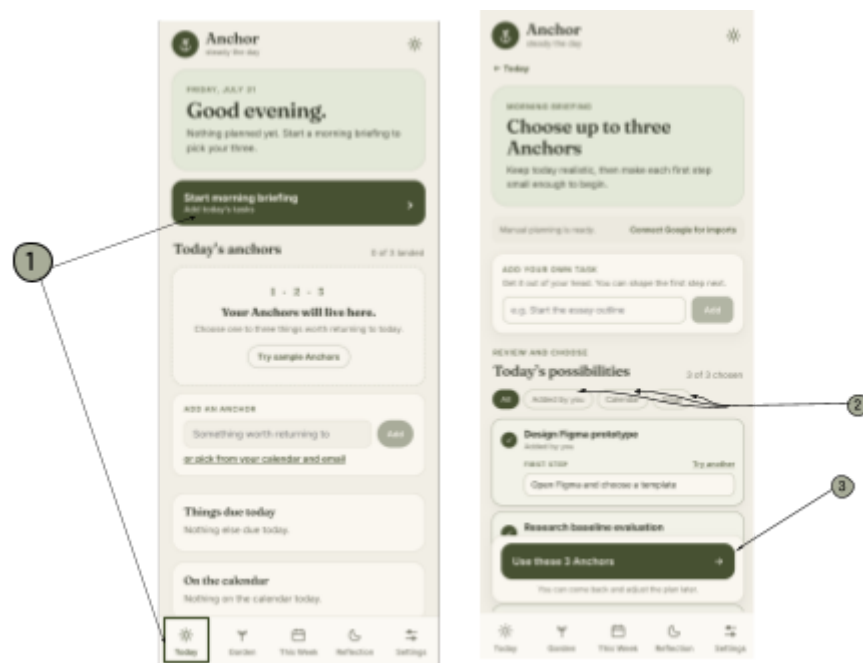


Figure 3: Anchor App Today and Morning Briefing Page

1. From the *Today* screen, tap the Morning Briefing banner
2. Under Today's possibilities, review Calendar events and unread Gmail items pulled in automatically and click to select them as Anchors

- a. Optional: Type a task into the "Add your own task" field and tap the Add button
3. Select "Use these 3 Anchors" to confirm selections and they will appear on the Today screen as your sole focus of the day
 - a. Note: Each task lists the first step as a guidance
4. For each task, you can:
 - a. Start a 5-minute Focus Sprint to begin working, and tap the audio icon for song choice.
 - b. Mark it as Started to indicate you've begun the task.
 - c. Mark it as Complete once you've finished.
 - d. Edit the Anchor to update its title or details.
 - e. Move it to Tomorrow if you want to complete it another day

Expected result: Your 3 selected Anchors appear on the Today screen, replacing the empty state, ready to be tracked.

3.2 Tracking Progress

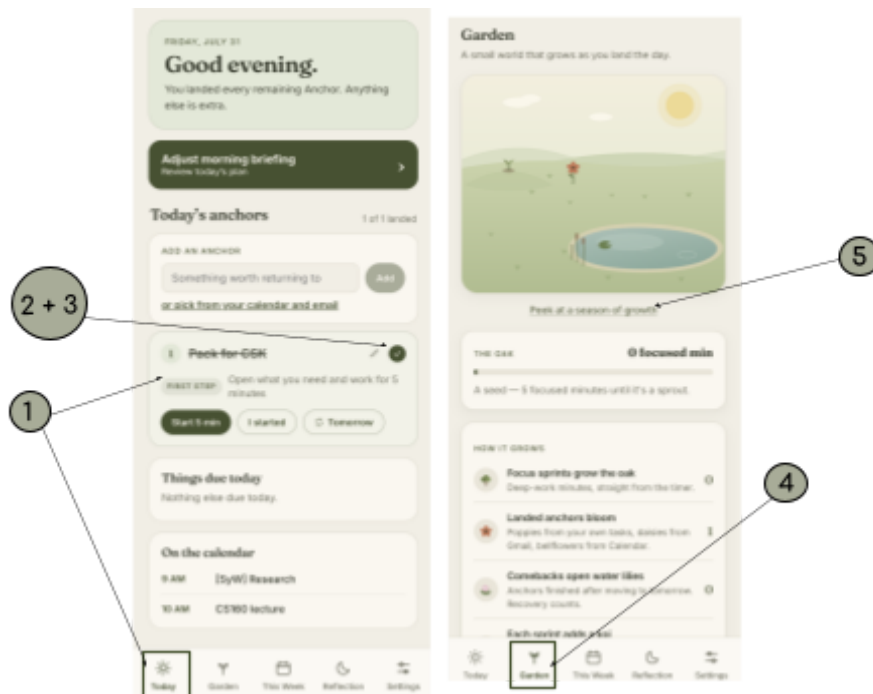


Figure 4: Anchor App Tracking Progress and Garden View

1. On the Today screen, locate your list of Anchors
2. Tap the circle beside an Anchor once you've completed it
3. Repeat for each Anchor as you finish it

4. Navigate to the Garden tab to view your visual progress for the day
 - a. Focus time collected from the timer
 - b. Completed Anchors bloom flowers
 - c. Anchors finished after being moved from tomorrow open water lilies
 - d. Completed focus sprints add Koi fish to the pond
5. Click on the “season of growth” to view overall progress while using the app

Expected result: The counter (e.g., “1 of 3 landed”) updates immediately after each check-off, and your Garden plant visibly grows as Anchors accumulate over time.

3.3 Schedule Planning



Figure 5: Schedule Planning and Weekly Briefing Page

1. Tap the This Week tab from the bottom navigation
2. Tap Start weekly briefing at the top to see a 7-day summary of open tasks and events
3. Scroll horizontally through the 7-day strip to view upcoming tasks and events for the week
4. Tap a specific day to select it
5. Review that day's listed tasks and events

6. Tap an individual item for more details

Expected result: The screen updates to show only the selected day's tasks and events, with a clear empty state shown if that day has nothing scheduled.

3.4 Evening Reflection



Figure 6: Evening Reflection Page

1. Tap the Reflections tab from the bottom navigation
2. Review the summary of complete and incomplete Anchors for the day
3. In Tonight's notes, log what helped or hindered your progress, sleep and steps
4. Tap "Close the Day" to log your reflection
 - a. Optional: Edit the reflection as needed

Expected result: Unfinished Anchors automatically appear as suggested items in tomorrow's Morning Briefing, and your notes are saved to that day's reflection log.

3.5 Managing Integration & Preferences



Figure 7: Settings and Preferences Page

1. Tap the Settings tab from the bottom navigation
2. Under account, review your signed-in status or tap Sign Out as needed
3. Under appearance, tap a color swatch to change your accent theme
 - a. Available themes are soft colored with options of: Sage (Green), Lavender (Purple), Ocean (Blue), and Terracotta (Orange)
4. Under reminders, tap Enable notifications and select allow on the browser prompt, toggle Daily reminders on, then set your Morning briefing and Night reflection times
5. Tap Send test notification to confirm it works, if the notifications are blocked the card shows instructions for re-enabling them in your browser's site settings (as pictured above)
6. Under Connections, tap "Connect Google" to link your Calendar and Gmail or Disconnect to remove access

Expected result: Connection status updates immediately (Connected/Disconnected), the app's accent color changes instantly across buttons and tabs, and account actions take effect right away with a confirmation before anything destructive (like deletion) occurs.

4. Known Limitations & Troubleshooting

4.1 Known Limitations

1. Anchor is currently optimized for mobile viewports (390px width). The implementation for a dedicated desktop layout is in progress
2. Gmail messages are filtered using a fixed set of rules to identify "task-like" emails; this filtering is not yet user-customizable.
3. "Continue with Google" sign-in is in progress. A combined Google sign-in (linking account creation with Calendar/Gmail access in one step) is still being finalized and may not be fully available.
4. Cafe and Rain sounds during the focus timer need some improvement.
5. Email verification is not enforced. New accounts are not currently required to verify their email address before signing in.
6. Account deletion has not been implemented.
7. Forget password leads to a blank screen on the app, as we are still making adjustments to Supabase.
8. Anchor limit is fixed. Users can select a maximum of 3 Anchors per day, and this limit is not currently adjustable.
9. Notifications are blocked by the browser, unless the tab has been granted permission.

4.2 Troubleshooting

Issue	Solution
No tasks or events are showing	Add a task manually or connect to your Google account to import calendar events

	and unread email as tasks. Or “try sample Anchors” to fill with sample data
Unauthorized to sign in and connect Google Account	Request through Github to get email access as a test user
Notifications are blocked for this site.	To turn them on, open your browser's site settings (the icon next to the address bar), allow Notifications, then reload this page.
A reminder has never arrived	Set notification to allow
Mobile design on desktop screen	Desktop implementation is still in progress. Change the width of the screen to simulate a mobile device. Or in the DevTools panel that opens, look for a small icon that looks like a phone/tablet outline near the top-left of the DevTools panel (next to the Elements/Console tabs)

4.3 FAQs

1) Can other users see my tasks or progress?

No. Your plans, reflections, and focus sessions are private to your account.

2) What happens to tasks I don't complete?

They roll over automatically and appear as suggestions in the next day's Morning Briefing.

3) Can I add another task after having three added already?

No. You can only add at most 3 tasks, as we don't want you to be overwhelmed with tasks.